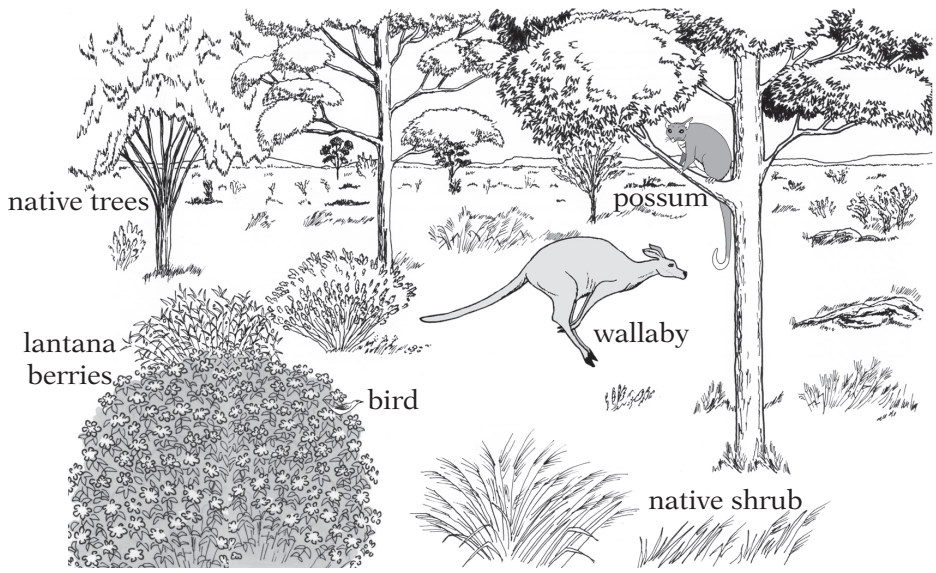
Introduced species – Lantana

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the passage below.

Word bank
eat plant poisonous weed soil stems Seeds native spread grows riverbanks flowers

Lantana is a plant **native** to Mexico and Central America. After it was introduced to Australia it s_____ rapidly, and has become a serious w_____ problem. Lantana thrives in cleared areas or sunny spots along r_____. The leaves are p_____ to animals. Because nothing will eat lantana, it g_____ quickly, forming a dense thicket with prickled s_____. It smothers n_____ vegetation and also releases a chemical into the s_____ that prevents **germination** of other plants. Lantana f_____ are colourful and attractive. Birds e_____ the berries. S_____ are then spread in the birds' droppings. One lantana p_____ can produce up to 12 000 seeds per year.



2 Draw arrows linking the organisms in the illustration to create a food web showing what foods they eat.

3 As the lantana population grows in a habitat, what will happen to the native trees and shrubs? _____

4 What will happen to the possums and wallabies over time? _____

_____

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